

added across the nodes? In a distributed system, the transactions may arrive in a different sequence on various nodes. There needs to be an agreed-upon protocol, which can be trusted by all, in order to prevent a rogue system from dominating the blockchain.

In the case of Bitcoins, the miners approve the transactions. They get the right to approve a transaction by solving a complex mathematical puzzle as a proof of work. This is necessary and an essential part of keeping the growth of Bitcoin currency in check. This, though, becomes a limitation when it comes to scaling the transaction rate.

In general, there is a need for protocols that ensure that a consensus is reached within all the active systems. Once the consensus is reached for a block of transactions, the agreed version of the truth is published, made available across the nodes and cannot be altered. Since the vote can be audited at any time, the protocol chosen for building consensus does not have to be very complex and computationally expensive for this case.

Why should we opt for this kind of voting?

The first advantage is that there are no hidden machines or

code. Everything is open for anyone to audit, including the data. The code and the process can be used anywhere, not just during major elections. A first step could very well be the university elections, including experimentation with near zero cost for canvassing.

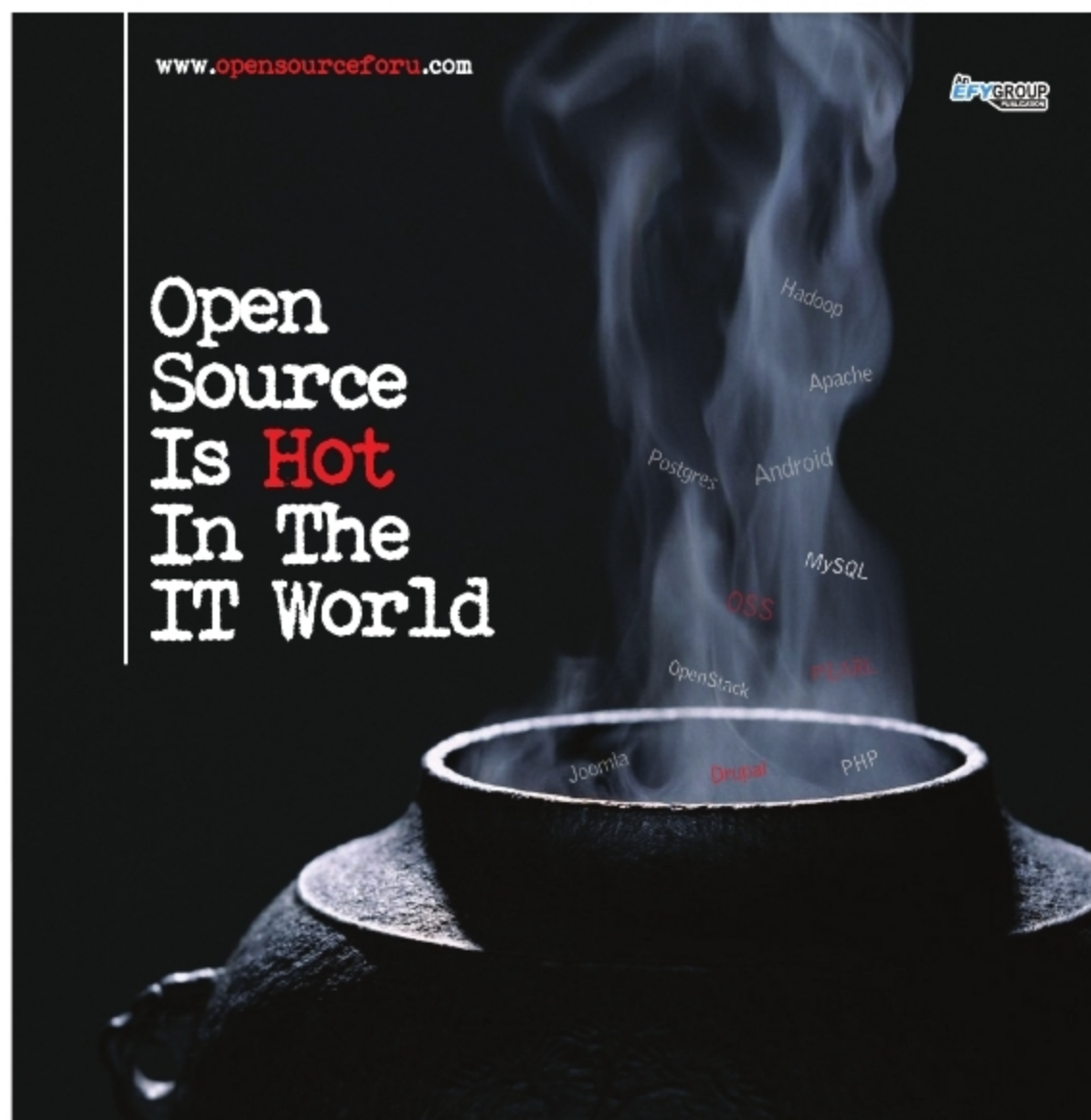
It can help modern parties start with internal democracy, as a default. The relative strength of various sub-groups need not be in doubt.

If the cost of holding an election is low, a run-off election, the option to recall a representative, or an automatic re-election in case a person wants to quit a party to join another — all become viable options.

Many countries across the world are beginning to experiment with this approach. There is no reason we shouldn't, especially if we wish to move ahead and lead in software technologies. **END** 🐧

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The author has earned the right to do what interests him. You can find him online at <http://sethanil.com> and <http://sethanil.blogspot.com>, or you can reach him via email at anil@sethanil.com.



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